

Ottawa County Clerk of Courts

Website Accessibility Improvements Report

Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA | Date: May 2025 | Prepared by: Digital Kingdom Interprises

Project Scope: Audit and remediation of accessibility barriers across the Ottawa County Clerk of Courts website (*ottawacountyclerkofcourts.com*) to meet ADA compliance requirements under WCAG 2.1 Level AA. Changes cover semantic HTML structure, ARIA attributes, keyboard navigation support, screen reader compatibility, heading hierarchy, image alt text, form labeling, and link context.

Pages Summary

File	Page / Component	Status	Fixes Applied
nav.php	Site-Wide Navigation	Complete	13
foot.php	Site-Wide Footer	Complete	6
index.php	Home Page	Complete	7
titles.php	Title Office	Complete	11
packets.php	Legal Packets	Complete	10
fees.php	Fees	Pending	—
records.php	Records	Pending	—
contact.php	Contact	Pending	—
links.php	Links	Pending	—

nav.php — Site-Wide Navigation 13 fixes

- Added `role="alert"` to the notice/announcement div for screen reader announcements
- Added `aria-label="Site Header"` to the top utility navigation bar
- Added `aria-label="Main Navigation"` to the primary nav element
- Added `aria-label="Open navigation menu"` to the mobile hamburger button
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to the mobile menu icon (decorative)
- Added `aria-haspopup="true"` and `aria-expanded="false"` to all dropdown triggers
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to all dropdown caret/arrow icons (decorative)
- Added `aria-label="Pay Online (opens in new tab)"` to Pay Online links — desktop and mobile
- Added `aria-label` with new tab warnings to all Common Pleas external links
- Added `role="separator"` to visual divider list items
- Added `role="navigation"` `aria-label="Mobile Navigation"` to the mobile sidenav
- Added `aria-label="Clerk of Courts: Christopher Enoch"` to the name link
- Confirmed distinct `aria-label` values on both nav elements to avoid duplicate landmark names

foot.php — Site-Wide Footer 6 fixes

- Added `role="contentinfo"` to the footer element
- Changed `<h3>` site name to `<p>` — footer does not require a heading
- Wrapped mailing address in `<address>` semantic element
- Changed plain phone number text to `<a href="tel:...">` with `aria-label="Phone: 419-..."`
- Added `aria-label="Fax: 419-..."` to fax number
- Added `aria-label="... (opens in new tab)"` to external footer link

index.php — Home Page 7 fixes

- Updated page title: `Home | Ottawa County Clerk of Courts`
- Added skip navigation link: `<a href="#main-content" class="skip-link">Skip to main content</a>`
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper around page content
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to empty decorative banner div
- Changed `<div role="navigation">` to proper semantic `<nav>` element
- Added descriptive `alt` text to all service card images
- Confirmed single H1 heading per page structure

titles.php — Title Office 11 fixes

- Updated page title: Titles | Ottawa County Clerk of Courts
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to decorative arrow icon
- Changed service card headings from H4 to H3 (Titles, Passports, Watercraft Registrations) — fixed heading skip H1 → H4
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrappers around `<ul>` lists in all 3 service cards
- Added phone tel link in Passports card: `<a href="tel:4197346752" aria-label="Phone: 419-734-6752">`
- Added `role="separator"` to divider list items in the contact info card
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 9 BMV automobile form links
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 3 Watercraft PDF links
- Added `aria-label` with new tab warnings to all external links (Ohio BMV, Ohio DNR, Ohio Tax)

packets.php — Legal Packets 10 fixes

- Updated page title: Legal Packets | Ottawa County Clerk of Courts
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Changed dynamically generated card headings from H4 to H2 — fixed heading skip H1 → H4
- Changed card-reveal panel title from H5 to `<p>` — avoids broken heading hierarchy inside expanded panels
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to `more_vert` Material icon (decorative)
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to `close` Material icon in card-reveal panel (decorative)
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrapper around `<ul>` document list in card-reveal
- Added dynamic `aria-label` with new tab warning to all external document links
- Added dynamic `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warning to all PDF document links

Pages Remaining 4 pending

File	Page
fees.php	Fees
records.php	Records

<code>contact.php</code>	Contact
<code>links.php</code>	Links